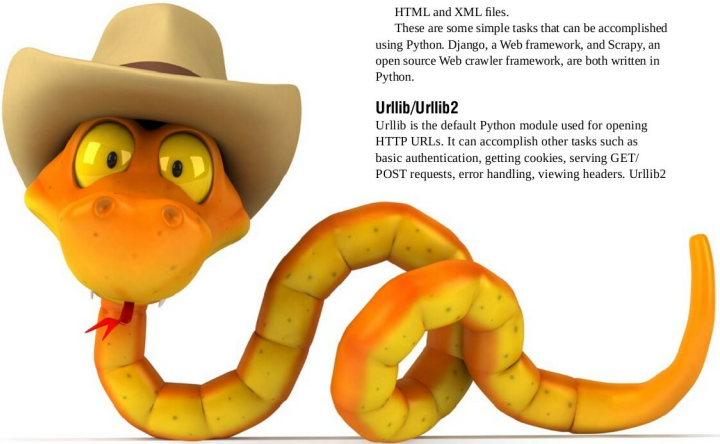


Python Requests: Interacting with the Web Made Easy

'Requests' is an Apache 2 HTTP library written in Python. Delve deeper into the topic and learn how it can be installed, and how Python Requests can be used to your advantage.



HTML and XML files.

These are some simple tasks that can be accomplished using Python. Django, a Web framework, and Scrapy, an open source Web crawler framework, are both written in Python.

Urllib/Urllib2

Urllib is the default Python module used for opening HTTP URLs. It can accomplish other tasks such as basic authentication, getting cookies, serving GET/POST requests, error handling, viewing headers. Urllib2

Python contains libraries that make it easy to interact with websites to perform tasks like logging into Gmail, viewing Web pages, filling forms, viewing and saving cookies—with nothing more than a few lines of code. Once a request is sent to a server, a Python script returns the information in almost the same way as a browser. Hence, the work done by a Python script is more or less similar to that of a Web browser. Some reasons why Python is preferred for accessing the Web are:

- Scripts can be written to automate interaction with a Web page.
- RSS feeds can be obtained and parsed.
- A Web spider to test your site or search other sites can be written.
- BeautifulSoup (a Python module) is used for parsing

is an improved Python module and provides additional functionalities to several methods. Hence some urllib methods have been replaced by urllib2 methods. One such method is `urllib.urlopen()`, which has been replaced by `urllib2.urlopen()` in the later versions of Python Requests. `urllib2.urlopen()` can accept an instance of a request class as an argument, which allows you to specify headers that are capable of fetching URLs using a variety of different protocols like HTTP or FTP; it can also accept a request object to set the headers for a URL request. On the other hand, `urllib.urlopen()` accepts only a URL.

In spite of having additional features, urllib cannot be completely replaced by urllib2 since the former provides important methods (e.g., `urlencode()`), used for generating GET query strings) that are absent in urllib2. Hence, methods from